

FOOD AND FARMING STUDY GUIDE

Everything you need to know!



KEY VOCABULARY (DEFINITIONS TO MEMORIZE)

- Subsistence farmers:** Farmers who grow crops and keep animals to feed themselves and their families.
- Commercial farms:** Large farms run as a business to make money by selling products.
- Crops:** Plants that people plant and grow to use.
- Cash crops:** Crops grown specifically to be sold for profit (e.g., sugar cane, maize).
- Livestock:** Animals kept on a farm for food, wool, milk, or leather.
- Climate:** The type of weather that a place has over a long period of years.
- Hail:** Frozen rain drops that form "stones" of ice and can damage crops.
- Unprocessed food:** Food that is in its natural, raw state (e.g., fresh apples, lettuce).
- Processed food:** Food that has been changed from its raw, natural state into something else (e.g., potatoes changed into chips).

TYPES OF FRUIT

Tropical fruit



Fruit from trees that grow in hot, wet places (e.g., mangoes, bananas, pineapples, avocados).

Deciduous fruit



Fruit from trees that lose their leaves in winter and grow best in areas with cold winters and dry summers (e.g., grapes, apples, peaches, pears).

Citrus fruit



Fruits that ripen in cold winters, like oranges, lemons, grapefruit, and naartjies.

ANIMAL FARMING & PRODUCTS



Stock farm: A farm where animals are kept.



Poultry: Birds that are farmed for food or products (e.g., chickens, ostriches).



Product: Something produced or manufactured to be sold.



Dairy products: Products made from milk, such as butter and cheese.

1 WAYS OF FARMING

Feature	Subsistence Farming	Commercial Farming
Main Purpose	To feed the farmer's own family. 	To sell products as a business for profit. 
Farm Size	Usually small plots of land. 	Very large farms. 
Who Does the Work?	Mostly women, children and the elderly. 	Paid farm workers and managers. 
Tools Used	By hand using simple tools (spades, hoes). 	Big machines (tractors, combine harvesters). 
Crop Variety	Grows a variety of food to eat. 	Often grows only one type of crop on a large scale. 

2 CROP FARMING IN SOUTH AFRICA

Different crops need different types of climate (weather) to grow well:



Maize (Mealies): Grown in many parts of South Africa. It is a staple food eaten daily as mealie meal or porridge.



Sugar Cane: Grows best in a warm climate with lots of summer rain (like KwaZulu-Natal).



Sunflowers: Grown mainly in the Free State to look pretty and to make cooking oil and margarine.



Apples and Pears: Cannot grow well where there is summer hail, because hail damages the fruit on the trees.

3 STOCK FARMING (ANIMALS AND THEIR PRODUCTS)

Animals on farms are divided into three groups:

- Large Stock:** Cattle (cows and bulls).
- Small Stock:** Sheep, goats, and pigs.
- Poultry:** Farmed birds like chickens and ostriches.

QUICK-REFERENCE ANIMAL PRODUCT LIST



Sheep: Provide wool and meat.



Chickens: Provide eggs and meat.



Ostriches: Provide feathers, meat, eggs, and leather. (Ostrich shells can also be used for decorations).



Pigs: Provide meat and leather.



Cattle: Provide meat, leather, and dairy products (milk, cheese, butter).

4 LOCATION OF FARMS & FOOD PROCESSING

WHY FARM LOCATION MATTERS



Proximity to Cities: Dairy farms and fresh vegetable farms are usually located near cities and towns. This ensures the food stays fresh and can get to shop shelves quickly before spoiling.

HOW AND WHY WE PROCESS FOOD

Food is processed by methods like peeling, squeezing, chopping, mixing, frying, baking, boiling, or braaing.



WHY WE PROCESS FOOD

To make it safe or soft enough to eat, to create new products, or to make it last longer.

EXAMPLES



Sugar cane is processed into sugar.



Wheat grains are ground down to create flour.



5 FROM FARM TO FACTORY TO SHOP (THE STORY OF BREAD)

The journey of wheat from the farm to your sandwich!

1 PLOUGH



Farmers plough the fields to prepare the soil.

2 PLANT



Special machines plant the wheat seeds into the ground.

3 GROW



The wheat plants grow tall and turn into golden-yellow seeds while workers weed the fields.

4 HARVEST



The wheat grains are harvested using a machine called a combine harvester.

5 MILL



The grains are taken to a factory or mill and ground down into flour.

6 BAKE



The flour goes to a bakery, is mixed with water and yeast to make dough, and is baked in large ovens into bread.

7 SELL



Delivery trucks transport fresh bread to shops where consumers buy it to make a sandwich.



ENJOY YOUR SANDWICH!



REMEMBER:

Farming gives us the food we eat every day. From the soil to the shop – many people and processes work together to put food on our tables!